

Techie friendship band

Friendship bands are all the rage now – gifted on special days, parties or just about any time you want to connect with a friend. While even a simple thread can serve to remind you of a loved one, what if the band also had facilities to record and recall memories? Mnemo, designed by Frog, is an interactive friendship bracelet that enables you to record, relive and share time spent with your friends using pictures, audio and location information. The bracelets are collectible and customisable. Although designed for single-event use, two or more can be linked together to combine common moments and create collective memories of shared experiences.

What's inside: Mnemo is constructed with a brushed copper and steel perforated body, with magnetic snaps and cast rubber bands. People can weave colourful threads through the bracelet to customise it as per their wishes. It has a clear touch sensor, a Bluetooth 4.0 chip, a near-field communications (NFC) chip and a flexible battery. When a user wears the bracelet for the first time, he activates it by simply holding it close to his phone. When the event begins, he can set it in record mode. Mnemo starts collecting time and location information, and snapshots of people, media and music. To relive memories after they have been recorded, users simply have to tap the wristband on their phone or attach it to a computer with the dongle. Once connected, they can scroll through a timeline of collected memories. To share overlapping memories with friends, two or more bands are linked together during or after recording, and common memories from all users combined to create a collective memory.

Web: http://info.frogdesign.com/rs/aricent/images/frog_Mobile_Ecosystems-Wearable-Technology.pdf



Intelligent saucepan that prevents spills and accidents

London design agency Precipice created Simr as part of BBC's Imagineering project, but it is something we would all like to have in our kitchens! The goal of Simr, an intelligent saucepan, is to improve cooking skills, reduce accidents, and make product care and maintenance easier. The saucepan has a lid that can be tilted to allow steam to escape and for straining; twin skin construction that allows a heat exchanger to be used between the skins to provide more even heat distribution; and a curved design and hydrophobic coating that make cleaning easier. A removable smart module on the handle monitors cooking temperature, weight, etc., and sounds an alarm if the contents are about to boil over.

What's inside: Using advanced analytics, Precipice looked at consumer expectations, desires and concerns, together with discursive analysis (the conversations in culture), semiotic codes (clusters of visual meaning) and cultural/visual trends to identify key design opportunities. The team then investigated these opportunity areas to focus and identify potential product solutions. Visual language, colours, materials and finishes, human factors and new technologies were incorporated into the design to meet the identified needs. Simr has a unique construction, using a distinctive mono-frame handle component, which allows a twin-skin bowl assembly. This double wall thickness provides many benefits: it helps fit in a heat exchanger, improves heat distribution and energy efficiency, and also keeps the outside wall temperature low. Heat and temperature sensors allow Simr to identify when the pan is about to boil over or boil dry, and actively warn the user. The removable smart handle has several modes including a timer, a weighing mechanism, a thermometer, and an alarm for the pot boiling over. A removable digital display provides live feedback on temperature, weight and timing of the saucepan contents. The design suggests conventional materials like steel and copper for the saucepan, with touch points moulded in colour-coded elastomers to provide better grip, visual reference points and insulated details. Internal surfaces are coated in a superhydrophobic coating for non-stick properties and easy cleaning. Aluminium is used for the handle for lightness and strength, and polycarbonates are used for the scratch-resistant screen.

Web: <http://www.precipice-design.com/bbc-futures-rebooting-the-saucepan>



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